

Boston Sunday Globe

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Vaccine trials target a source of teen angst

Firms aim to end acne with just a few shots

By Allyson Chiu
GLOBE STAFF

For many people with acne, trying to get rid of the stubborn bumps can be a time-consuming and costly struggle.

But researchers say they're working on a solution that could clear your skin and your medicine cabinet: a vaccine.

At least two companies in the

United States, both with Massachusetts ties, are developing novel shots, among the first of their kind, that target the bacteria associated with breakouts. They say acne shouldn't be dismissed as a cosmetic problem or teenage rite of passage. The condition can inflict lasting damage, including physical scars, anxiety, and depression. And for some, it lasts well into adulthood.

Instead of daily regimens of creams and pills that often manage the condition rather than

ACNE, Page A8

A Fenway streak that still stands



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Peter Dankens started working at Fenway Park 50 years ago, in the era of Yaz and Jim Rice.

Year after year, Peter Dankens serves the park faithful

By Dana Gerber
GLOBE STAFF

Hours before the Red Sox take the field, Peter Dankens winds through the mostly empty corridors of Fenway Park, to the concessions stand behind first base, and begins his own ballgame.

Already, the coolers at Baseline Beer are stocked with frosty Narragansetts and Truly Hard Seltzers, bags of peanuts piled high on top. It's quiet now, but just wait: As the gates open and thirsty fans start lining up, Dankens, 64, will step up to the plate — or, rather, a sleek point-of-sale system — and crack cans through the bottom of the seventh inning.

It's a familiar routine for Dankens, Fenway's longest-serving concessions worker. He started at the ballpark 50 years ago, at age 14, when hot dogs cost 55 cents and the Sox were the team of Yastrzemski and Rice. "I always loved it," said Dankens, a bespectacled man with a toothy grin and gray hair

FENWAY, Page A15

Summer sol; diss

Sunday: Some sun.
High 79, low 61.

Monday: Storms, rain.

Sunrise: 5:07. Sunset: 8:25.

Complete report, **A22**.

Obituaries, **A21**.

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Iran dealt two blows to its agreement with the US, saying it had closed the Strait of Hormuz because of continued fighting in Lebanon and downplaying upcoming talks. **A2**.

Local poll respondents overwhelmingly objected to the concept of congestion pricing — paying extra to drive to downtown Boston during peak traffic hours. **B1**.

Looking for a nonexotic island hop? Check out camping on Boston Harbor's Peddocks Island. **Travel, N11**.



PHOTO ILLUSTRATION BY ASHLEY BORG/GLOBE STAFF, ADOBE STOCK

CAN THIS COMPANY TAKE VERMONT TO NEW HEIGHTS?

Electric aviation pioneer Beta Technologies is having an outsized effect on the local economy

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE STAFF

SOUTH BURLINGTON, Vt. — From 1,600 feet above sea level, the Champlain Valley, with its signature lake and mix of farmland, forest, and suburbia, doesn't look like the birthplace of a new era in aviation.

But from his vantage point in the cockpit of an experimental electric airplane, Chris Caputo sees the future of aeronautics taking off in this northwest corner of Vermont.

"We're going to put Champlain Valley on the map," said Caputo, flight operations chief for Beta Technologies, as he steered a prototype plane above the lakeshore on a clear blue afternoon in early June. "You know, not all smart people live in Silicon Valley."

In less than a decade, South Burlington-based Beta has emerged as an unlikely front-runner in the race to create an entirely new industry: electric airplanes that take off and land like a helicopter and soar through the skies without a drop of jet fuel.



CALEB KENNA FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Already a multibillion-dollar publicly traded company, Beta is slated to fly cargo and medical supplies around the country in the coming months as part of a federal demonstration.

BETA, Page A10

Beta Technologies has a facility at the airport in South Burlington, Vt.

A World Cup dividend: pocket-size pitches

Boom in mini-fields set to capitalize on soccer fever

By Chris Serres
GLOBE STAFF

At 10 years old, on a summer trip to visit relatives in Timóteo, Brazil, Felipe Pinto discovered a simple truth about soccer: The game requires very little to flourish.

The Brockton native fell in

love with the beautiful game on what soccer-mad Brazilians call a "quadra" — a fenced-in expanse, no bigger than two tennis courts, tucked between the city's apartment blocks. With just a few players on each side, they played with whatever they could find. Sandals and backpacks served as

goalposts, and the ball was often nothing more than mismatched socks stuffed inside one another and bound with rubber bands. Free from parents, coaches, or referees, they kicked until dusk and ran until their feet blistered, Pinto recalled.

"When you're a child, that

cramped space can feel like a giant stadium, like thousands of people are cheering you on," Pinto said. "It was just us kids, having fun."

Now 25, Pinto is at the forefront of an ambitious effort to bring such soccer to the masses here in New England through a network of smaller soccer

MINI-PITCHES, Page A15

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